SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

13 September 2023 · Shift 1

44 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 46 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 20 questions

Q.1

According to Census of India 2011, what was the total population of India (approx)?

(A) 131 Crore
(B) 121 Crore
(C) 111 Crore
(D) 101 Crore

Q.2

Chhau is a major dance tradition of India. In which of the following Indian states is the dance form NOT prevalent?

(A) Odisha
(B) West Bengal
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.3

In November 2022, which state became the first North-East state to approve Mental Health and Social Care Policy?

(A) Assam
(B) Meghalaya
(C) Tripura
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.4

In which state is Vishakhapatnam Port located?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Odisha
(D) Gujarat

Q.5

Who among the following is the Indian classical dancer who masters both Bharatanatyam and Odissi dancing style?

(A) Shovana Narayan
(B) Guru Bipin Singh
(C) Padma Subrahmanayam
(D) Sonal Mansingh

Q.6

Which bacteria was discovered by Barry Marshall and Robin Warren that colonises the human stomach and causes chronic superficial gastritis ulcers?

(A) Campylobacter jejuni
(B) Helicobacter pylori
(C) Neisseria gonorrhoeae
(D) Entamoeba histolytica

Q.8
What is a prominent trend in the microfinance sector in India?

(A) Integration of mobile banking services
(B) Excessive bureaucracy in loan approvals
(C) Decreased reliance on digital technology
(D) Limited focus on women entrepreneurs

Q.10
The famous coal mining region 'Korba' is located in which state of India?

(A) Kerala
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Chhattisgarh
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.11
What do you mean by balanced budget?

(A) Expenditure not equal to revenue
(B) Expenditure equal to revenue
(C) Expenditure more the revenue
(D) Expenditure is less than revenue

Q.12
Rajgir Mahotsav is a beautiful representation of history, religion, art and culture. It is a three-day celebration in _____.

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Uttarakhand
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Bihar

Q.13
The famous novel 'The God Of Small Things' is written by _____.

(A) Shashi Tharoor
(B) Ruskin Bond
(C) Vikram Seth
(D) Arundhati Roy

Q.14
The Men's Junior Hockey Asia Cup 2023, which was won by India, was held at _____.

(A) Saudi Arabia
(B) Oman
(C) Dubai
(D) Qatar

Q.15
In the context of the Revolt of 1857, Mangal Pandey belonged to which Bengal native Infantry?

(A) 34
(B) 52
(C) 70
(D) 64

Q.16
Which of the following countries did India beat in the final to win the 2021 SAFF Championship?

(A) Nepal
(B) Lebanon
(C) Maldives
(D) Kuwait

Q.17
Vinesh Phogat became the first Indian woman wrestler to win how many medals at World Championships?

(A) 6
(B) 5
(C) 2
(D) 3

Q.18
What is the purpose of the Cultural and Educational Rights?

(A) To promote a particular religion
(B) To protect the language, culture, and religion of the minority communities
(C) To protect the majority community
(D) To prevent exploitation

Q.19
In optics, which term refers to the opening of the diaphragm of a lens that spatially limits the propagation of light?

(A) Collimator
(B) Aperture
(C) Apostilb
(D) Meniscus

Q.22
In which city is the Rajghat memorial situated?

(A) Ahmedabad
(B) Surat
(C) Delhi
(D) Agra

Q.23
In the 1939 Tripuri Congress Presidential Election, Pattabhi Sitaramayya was defeated by:

(A) Mahatma Gandhi
(B) Rajendra Prasad
(C) Subhas Chandra Bose
(D) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q.25
In which year was the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganization Act passed?

(A) 2019
(B) 2009
(C) 2015
(D) 2017

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The toddler decided to make a mess because he wanted to _____ the attention of its parents.

(A) seek
(B) elicit
(C) please
(D) extract

Q.2
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Glimpse

(A) Examine
(B) Glance
(C) Stare
(D) Observe

Q.3
Identify the sentence that contains correct spellings in the given context.

(A) She acid the test despite being sleep-deprived from studying for nearly 24 hours straight.
(B) She acad the test desspite being sleep-deprived from studying for nearly 24 hours straight.
(C) She aced the test daspite being sleep-deprived from studying for nearly 24 hours strait.
(D) She aced the test despite being sleep-deprived from studying for nearly 24 hours straight.

Q.4
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The teacher assured: “You have completed your homework, _____?”

(A) had you
(B) hadn’t you
(C) haven’t you
(D) have you

Q.5
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. A _____(distinct) sense of restlessness was bothering me when I left the cemetery.

(A) terrible
(B) critical
(C) prior
(D) vague

Q.6

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. With cloud streaming, people can play games from a / internet-connected device, avoiding the need for pricey / dedicated hardware such as a game console.

(A) No error
(B) dedicated hardware such as a game console
(C) With cloud streaming, people can play games from a
(D) internet-connected device, avoiding the need for pricey

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Keep someone at arm's length

(A) To ruin someone's plans
(B) To avoid becoming too close or friendly with someone
(C) Angry about something
(D) Having energy again after being tired

Q.8

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) This fridge / (B) comes including / (C) a 5-year / (D) warranty.

(A) B
(B) C
(C) D
(D) A

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who looks at the dark side of life

(A) Physicist
(B) Optimist
(C) Pessimist
(D) Idealist

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Many "a things are" used for the show.

(A) a things is
(B) a things were
(C) a thing is
(D) a thing were

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option that can rectify the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to rectify it, select 'no rectification needed'. This film is a non-stop riot that many cite as one of the "funny" films of all time.

(A) no rectification needed
(B) funniest
(C) more funny
(D) funnier

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Essence
(B) Aggregate
(C) Transmisible
(D) Assembly

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who regards the whole world as his country

(A) Cosmopolitan
(B) Pacifist
(C) Contemporary
(D) Celibate

Q.14

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. The team played / really well, but / they lose the game / in the final minutes.

(A) really well, but
(B) in the final minutes
(C) they lose the game
(D) The team played

Q.15

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. The school shall reopened / after summer / vacations of / one month.

(A) one month
(B) vacations of
(C) The school shall reopened
(D) after summer

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. They waited with “anxiety” for the final results.

(A) Shrewdness
(B) Wilderness
(C) Feebleness
(D) Calmness

Q.17

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Jack took on three jobs at once but soon realised he had _____.

(A) cut corners
(B) taken it with a grain of salt
(C) bitten off more than he could chew
(D) played by the ear

Q.18

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. The CEO has _____ than worrying about individual customer complaints.

(A) bigger fish to fry
(B) taken a rain check
(C) thrown caution to the wind
(D) been walking on thin ice

Q.20

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. I know it was wrong to distract his friends, but _____.

(A) all’s fair in love and war
(B) all’s unfair in the world
(C) all’s unfair in love and war
(D) all’s fair in the world

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. (1)___ the breakfast table the next morning, there was no sign of my wife. I (2)___ she was sleeping late, but Gladolia, upon being questioned, only (3)___ her head, (4)___ something, and turned the whites of her eyes up to the ceiling. I was glad when the meal was (5)___ and hurried to the library for another try at that story.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) On
(B) Above
(C) Upon
(D) At

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. (1)___ the breakfast table the next morning, there was no sign of my wife. I (2)___ she was sleeping late, but Gladolia, upon being questioned, only (3)___ her head, (4)___ something, and turned the whites of her eyes up to the ceiling. I was glad when the meal was (5)___ and hurried to the library for another try at that story.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) accepted
(B) decided
(C) examined
(D) concluded

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. (1)___ the breakfast table the next morning, there was no sign of my wife. I (2)___ she was sleeping late, but Gladolia, upon being questioned, only (3)___ her head, (4)___ something, and turned the whites of her eyes up to the ceiling. I was glad when the meal was (5)___ and hurried to the library for another try at that story.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) adjusted
(B) rotated
(C) shook
(D) stirred

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. (1)___ the breakfast table the next morning, there was no sign of my wife. I (2)___ she was sleeping late, but Gladolia, upon being questioned, only (3)___ her head, (4)___ something, and turned the whites of her eyes up to the ceiling. I was glad when the meal was (5)___ and hurried to the library for another try at that story.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) mugged
(B) muffed
(C) mutilated
(D) muttered

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. (1)___ the breakfast table the next morning, there was no sign of my wife. I (2)___ she was sleeping late, but Gladolia, upon being questioned, only (3)___ her head, (4)___ something, and turned the whites of her eyes up to the ceiling. I was glad when the meal was (5)___ and hurried to the library for another try at that story.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) removed
(B) over
(C) through
(D) undone

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**
Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**
Q.23 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**				

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) 121 Crore

The 2011 Census put India's population at 1,210.85 million, about 121 crore.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Madhya Pradesh

Chhau has three styles, named after where they are danced: Seraikella in Jharkhand, Purulia in West Bengal and Mayurbhanj in Odisha. It is not a tradition of Madhya Pradesh.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Meghalaya

The Meghalaya cabinet approved the State Mental Health and Social Care Policy at the end of November 2022, making Meghalaya the first state in the North-East with such a policy.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Andhra Pradesh

Visakhapatnam Port, one of India's major ports on the east coast, is in Andhra Pradesh.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Sonal Mansingh

Sonal Mansingh trained in Bharatanatyam and then in Odissi under Kelucharan Mohapatra, and performs both. Padma Subrahmanyam is a Bharatanatyam dancer, Shovana Narayan a Kathak dancer and Guru Bipin Singh a Manipuri dancer.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Helicobacter pylori

Barry Marshall and Robin Warren showed that the bacterium Helicobacter pylori causes gastritis and peptic ulcers, and received the 2005 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for it.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Integration of mobile banking services

Microfinance lenders increasingly use mobile banking and digital payments, paying loans straight into borrowers' bank accounts and taking repayments digitally. The other options describe the opposite of the sector: its small, collateral-free loans need little paperwork, it relies more, not less, on digital technology, and most of its borrowers are women.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Chhattisgarh

Korba, in Chhattisgarh, is one of India's largest coalfields and a centre of coal-fired power generation.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Expenditure equal to revenue

A budget is balanced when the government's expected expenditure equals its expected revenue; spending less than it receives gives a surplus budget, spending more a deficit budget.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Bihar

The Rajgir Mahotsav, a three-day festival of music and dance, is held at Rajgir in Nalanda district, Bihar.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Arundhati Roy

'The God of Small Things' is Arundhati Roy's first novel; it won the Booker Prize in 1997.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Oman

The 2023 Men's Junior Asia Cup was played at Salalah, Oman, in May and June 2023; India beat Pakistan 2-1 in the final for their fourth title.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 34

Mangal Pandey was a sepoy of the 34th Bengal Native Infantry; he attacked his officers at Barrackpore on 29 March 1857 and was hanged in April.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Nepal

India beat Nepal 3-0 in the final of the 2021 SAFF Championship, played at Malé, Maldives, in October 2021.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 2

Vinesh Phogat won bronze at the World Championships in 2019 and 2022, the first Indian woman wrestler with two World Championship medals.

Q.18 · Answer (B) To protect the language, culture, and religion of the minority communities
The Cultural and Educational Rights (Articles 29 and 30) let any section of citizens conserve its distinct language, script or culture, and let minorities, religious or linguistic, set up and run educational institutions of their choice.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Aperture
The aperture is the opening, set by the diaphragm, through which light enters, so it limits the light passing. A collimator makes rays parallel, the apostilb is an old unit of luminance and a meniscus is a lens convex on one side and concave on the other.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Delhi
Raj Ghat, on the bank of the Yamuna in Delhi, marks the spot where Mahatma Gandhi was cremated on 31 January 1948.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Subhas Chandra Bose
Subhas Chandra Bose was re-elected Congress president in January 1939, defeating Pattabhi Sitaramayya, whom Gandhi backed; Gandhi called the defeat his own. Bose presided at Tripuri in March 1939 and resigned the next month.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 2019
Parliament passed the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act in August 2019; from 31 October 2019 it divided the state into two Union territories, Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) seek
SSC's key gives 'seek': to seek attention is to try to get it, as in 'attention-seeking', which is what the toddler is doing. 'Elicit' normally takes a response, reaction or information as its object, and 'elicit attention' is found mainly in technical writing; 'please' and 'extract' do not fit.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Glance
A 'glimpse' is a brief look, and so is a 'glance'; to stare, examine or observe is to look long or closely.

Q.3 · Answer (D) She aced the test despite being sleep-deprived from studying for nearly 24 hours straight.
The correct spellings are 'aced' (did very well in), 'despite' and 'straight' (without a break); 'acid', 'acad', 'desspite', 'daspite' and 'strait' are wrong here.

Q.4 · Answer (C) haven’t you
A positive statement takes a negative question tag with the same auxiliary: 'You have completed your homework, haven't you?'

Q.5 · Answer (D) vague
'Distinct' means clear and definite; its opposite is 'vague', unclear: 'a vague sense of restlessness'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) With cloud streaming, people can play games from a
'Internet-connected' begins with a vowel sound, so it takes 'an', not 'a': 'from an internet-connected device'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) To avoid becoming too close or friendly with someone
To 'keep someone at arm's length' is to avoid becoming close or friendly with them.

Q.8 · Answer (A) B
A product 'comes with' what is included: 'This fridge comes with a 5-year warranty.'

Q.9 · Answer (C) Pessimist
A 'pessimist' expects the worst; an 'optimist' is the opposite, and an 'idealist' pursues high ideals.

Q.10 · Answer (C) a thing is
'Many a' takes a singular noun and a singular verb: 'Many a thing is used for the show.'

Q.11 · Answer (B) funniest
'One of the ... films of all time' ranks the film among all others, so it needs the superlative: 'one of the funniest films of all time'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Transmisible
The correct spelling is 'transmissible'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Cosmopolitan
A 'cosmopolitan' is a citizen of the world, at home anywhere; a pacifist opposes war, a contemporary lives at the same time as another, and a celibate abstains from marriage and sex.

Q.14 · Answer (C) they lose the game
The sentence tells of a past event ('played'), so the second verb must be past too: 'they lost the game'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) The school shall reopened
A modal such as 'shall' takes the base form of the verb: 'The school shall reopen'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Calmness
'Anxiety' is worry or unease; its opposite is 'calmness'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) bitten off more than he could chew
To 'bite off more than one can chew' is to take on more than one can manage, as Jack did with three jobs at once.

Q.18 · Answer (A) bigger fish to fry
To have 'bigger fish to fry' is to have more important matters to deal with.

Q.20 · Answer (A) all’s fair in love and war
The proverb 'all's fair in love and war' excuses any tactic in a contest one cares about; the other options change its fixed wording.

Q.21 · Answer (D) At
One sits 'at' a table, so the scene opens 'at the breakfast table'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) concluded
SSC's key gives 'concluded': from her absence the narrator inferred that she was sleeping late, and 'conclude' is the verb for judging something true from the evidence. 'Decided' can also mean 'came to think', so it is arguable, but its usual sense is making a choice; 'accepted' and 'examined' do not fit.

Q.23 · Answer (C) shook
One 'shakes' one's head to say no or show one does not know; the past tense 'shook' fits 'only ___ her head'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) muttered
To 'mutter' is to say something quietly and indistinctly, which fits '___ something'; 'mugged', 'muffed' and 'mutilated' do not.

Q.25 · Answer (B) over
A meal that is 'over' has ended: he was glad when breakfast was over and hurried to the library.

This paper online, with tap-to-reveal answers: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-mts/question-papers/mts-2023-13-sep-2023-shift-1/
Every solved SSC MTS paper: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-mts/question-papers/
Daily current affairs PDF, free, every morning on Telegram: t.me/parikshasaathiapp
Questions and official answers: the Staff Selection Commission (SSC). Explanations: drafted with AI assistance by Pariksha Saathi and checked against the official answers. Pariksha Saathi is not affiliated with any exam body. Spotted an error? Write to sriwastava2@gmail.com.